



High-octane play: (Left) Shai Gilgeous-Alexander (No. 2) scored 29 points and had 12 assists in the Thunder's 103-91 victory over the Indiana Pacers. (Above) Thunder's Chet Holmgren and Alex Caruso reach for a rebound against the Pacers in the first half of Game 3 of the 2025 NBA Finals in Indianapolis. AP

SGA remained steady and effective throughout, but Jalen Williams' inconsistent performances became the Thunder's biggest variable. Game 4 marked the Thunder's turning point. Trailing by 10 points in the fourth quarter, they mounted an epic comeback powered by SGA's clutch brilliance to even the series at 2-2.

With momentum shifting, the Thunder appeared poised to close out the series in Game 6 after easing to a win at home in Game 5, withstanding a furious Pacers fourth-quarter rally. But the Pacers had other plans.

Dramatic conclusion

Playing with the same defensive intensity that defined the Thunder, the Pacers dominated Game 6 in Indianapolis, forcing a winner-take-all Game 7. The vast talent gap between the teams seemed irrelevant as the series returned to Oklahoma City.

However, the Pacers faced a crucial concern. Haliburton had